

Kapil Wankhede

Social Entrepreneur — Institution Builder — Education Leader

 Website  Email  LinkedIn  GitHub  +91-9987880240  Nalanda Academy

PROFILE

First-generation social entrepreneur and institution builder from Wardha, Maharashtra. Growing up as the child of daily-wage construction labourers, I experienced how talented students from marginalized communities are often constrained by lack of information, mentorship, and opportunity.

Over the past decade, I have co-founded and helped scale Nalanda Academy, an educational movement supporting students from rural and marginalized communities through mentorship, community libraries, digital learning, leadership development, and residential education. Currently leading the development of the Nalanda Abhiyan Campus, a 9.15-acre residential learning ecosystem designed as a scalable model for inclusive education and social mobility.

SELECTED IMPACT

- **2,300+ students** supported in gaining admission to leading universities and institutions across India.
- **60+ students** enabled to pursue higher education internationally.
- **18,000+ digital learners** reached through Digital Nalanda.
- **15 community libraries** established across rural communities to expand access to books, guidance, and learning spaces.
- **250+ workshops** organized for educational guidance, leadership development, and community outreach.
- **9.15-acre Nalanda Abhiyan Campus** under development as a residential learning ecosystem for underrepresented students.

LEADERSHIP & SOCIAL INNOVATION EXPERIENCE

Nalanda Academy

Wardha, India

Co-Founder and Assistant Director

Jul 2013 – Present

- Co-founded and scaled Nalanda Academy as a grassroots educational movement focused on expanding opportunities for students from rural, tribal, nomadic, and marginalized communities.
- Built mentorship, academic guidance, leadership development, and community engagement systems to help first-generation learners access higher education.
- Led strategic planning, fundraising, partnerships, public relations, volunteer mobilization, curriculum development, and organizational growth.
- Supported students from highly disadvantaged backgrounds, including migrant labour, bonded labour, tribal, rural, and nomadic communities.
- Expanded Digital Nalanda as an online learning and mentoring platform reaching 18,000+ learners.
- Designed and operationalized 15+ Abhiyan Community Libraries to create community-owned learning spaces in rural areas.

Nalanda Abhiyan Campus

Waifad, Wardha, India

Director

Ongoing

- Leading the development of a 9.15-acre residential educational campus for students from underrepresented communities.
- Coordinating planning and implementation of hostels, classrooms, common spaces, library facilities, student support spaces, and STEM innovation labs.
- Conceptualized hands-on STEM labs for robotics, electronics, coding, and scientific experimentation for students with limited prior exposure to technology.
- Driving sustainability initiatives including a planned 120kW rooftop solar energy system to reduce operating costs and embed sustainability into campus life.
- Developing the campus as a replicable model for community-centered education, leadership development, and social mobility.

Sanghamitra Business Incubator

Wardha, India

Co-Founder and Chief Operations Officer

Jan 2019 – Dec 2021

- Co-founded a social entrepreneurship incubator focused on community-centered enterprise development and local innovation.
- Led operations across product design, market research, vendor sourcing, supply chain, quality control, sales, marketing, logistics, finance, and store operations.
- Launched and managed multiple initiatives during the COVID-19 period, including Sanghamitra business lines, e-commerce operations, and partnerships with Digital Nalanda.
- Trained local youth in operations, data collection, analysis, and digital tools; developed data applications for business analytics and product improvement.
- Established an engineering lab and community library; organized education and healthcare awareness programs.

SELECTED IMPACT STORIES

- **Educational Mobility:** Supported a student from a bonded labour family working across road construction sites in India who later entered university and pursued higher education.
- **Gender and Social Inclusion:** Mentored a young woman from a nomadic community where girls rarely continue education beyond school; she later completed a law degree and built a professional legal career.
- **Community Transformation:** Helped create local learning spaces where first-generation learners and families could access guidance, books, digital resources, and educational networks.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Mitsubishi UFJ Financial Group Union Bank

New York, USA

Quantitative Financial Analyst

Jun 2017 – Sep 2018

- Conducted model validation and quantitative risk analysis for regulatory, market risk, credit risk, and counterparty credit risk models.
- Managed a database of 900+ models and non-models to track validation status, governance requirements, and outstanding issues.
- Performed statistical testing and independent validation of Economic Capital VaR and scorecard-based credit risk rating models.
- Developed expertise in data-driven decision making, evidence-based analysis, organizational governance, and systems-level problem solving.

TECHNOLOGY & DATA FOR SOCIAL IMPACT

- **AI/Data Science:** Built applied machine learning projects in NLP, health prediction, A/B testing, and financial modelling.
- **Disaster Response Web App:** Developed an NLP-based application to classify emergency messages for disaster response.
- **Education Technology:** Applied digital platforms, analytics, and AI tools to expand access to learning, mentoring, and organizational decision-making.
- **Technical Skills:** Python, SQL, R, JavaScript, Streamlit, Git, Power BI, AWS, Scikit-Learn, Pandas, NumPy.

EDUCATION

Illinois Institute of Technology

Chicago, USA

Master of Science in Finance

Aug 2015 – May 2017

Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar Technological University

Raigad, India

Bachelor of Technology in Petrochemical Engineering

Aug 2008 – May 2012

Udacity

Online

Nanodegree in Applied Data Science

Jan 2020 – May 2020

SCHOLARSHIPS & RECOGNITION

- Recipient of Government of India scholarship to pursue postgraduate education abroad.
- Next Generation Tech Booster Scholarship for Agile Software Developer program from Udacity.
- Founder-level leadership in educational initiatives impacting thousands of students from marginalized communities.

FUTURE VISION

To build a national network of community-centered learning ecosystems that integrate mentorship, community libraries, technology, entrepreneurship, residential education, and local participation to expand opportunities for marginalized youth across India.